

FreeTX

User Manual



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FreeTX

FreeTX is an open-source radio control system for almost anything. Remotely operate model airplanes, multicopters, helicopters, boats, land vehicles, robots, animatronics, etc.

Main features

- 20 fully proportional RC channels, each encoded with 10 bits.
- Configurable RC channel output signal format.
- Update rate of 50x per second for all RC channels.
- Receiver binding, adjustable RF power, frequency hopping.
- Reverse, subtrim, endpoints, failsafe, dual rates and expo, custom curves, flight modes.
- Powerful mixer system, logical switches, function generators, counters, timers.
- Telemetry, alarms, warnings, notifications, home screen widgets, custom splash screen, etc.
- Model memory, I2C EEPROM and SD card supported. Model types, context-aware nomenclature.
- Intuitive user interface.

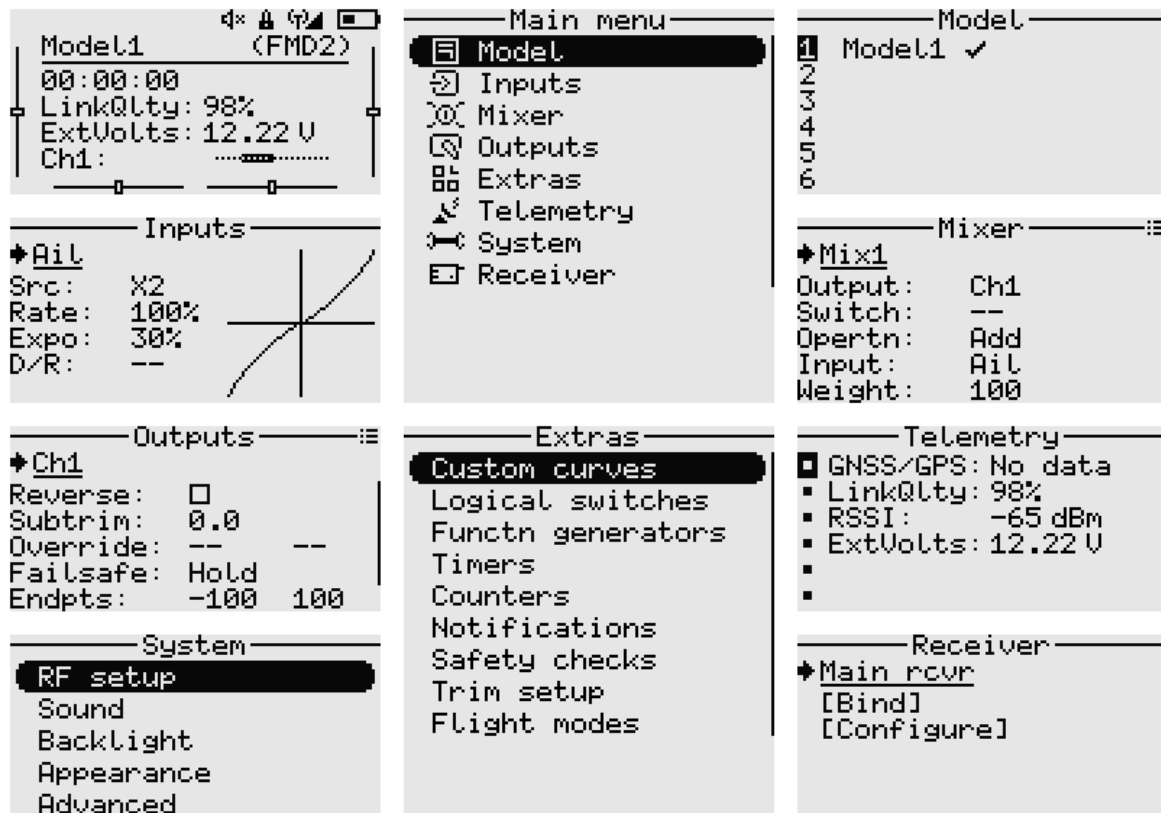
Hardware and Schematics

The transmitter and receiver schematics can be found in the Schematics folder. The major components are:-

- 1x Atmega2560 microcontroller, 2x Atmega328p microcontrollers.
- 2x SX1276/77/78/79 or RFM95 based Lora modules. Other RF modules can possibly be used with some modifications to the source code.
- A 128x64 graphical LCD with KS0108 or ST7920 controller. Any other 128x64 LCD can however be used (provide own driver code).

User interface

Three buttons are used for navigating the user interface i.e. Up, Select, Down. Long press Select to go Back.



Default configuration

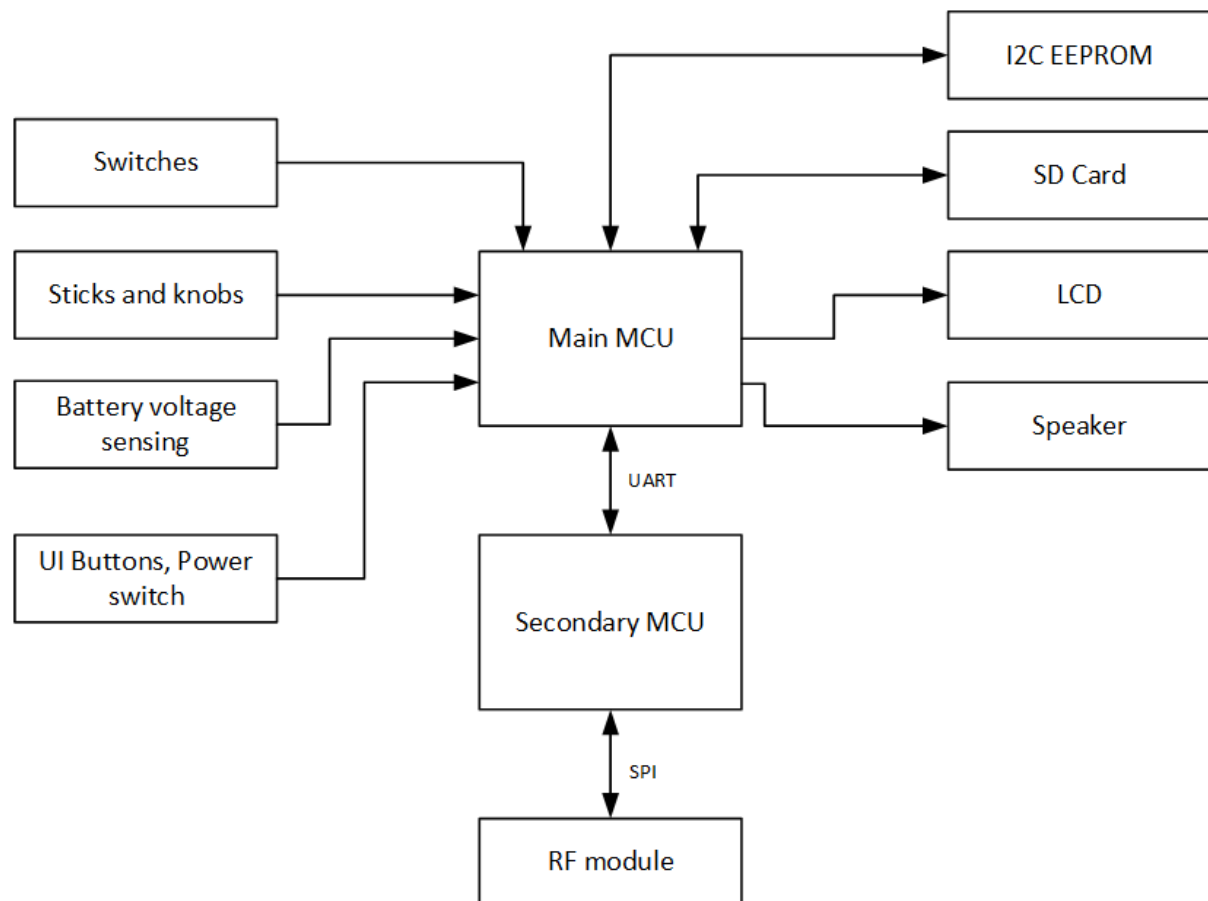
By default, the system is configured with the following features.

- 10 stick input axes, 8 switches, 2 knobs
- 40 mixer slots, 20 proportional RC channels
- 10 custom curves, 10 max points per curve
- 20 logical switches, 5 function generators, 3 timers, 5 counters
- 10 custom notifications
- 5 flight modes
- 8 telemetry sensor slots

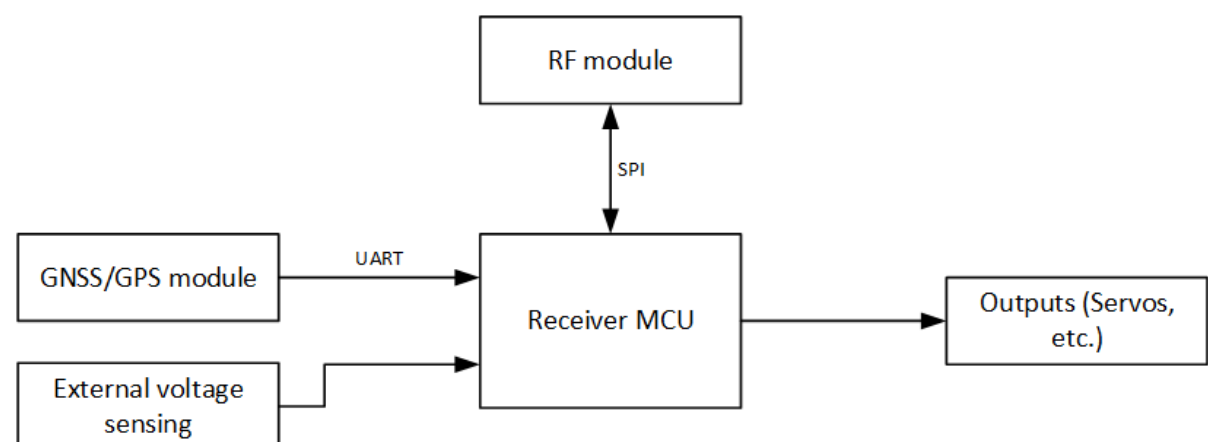
Many of these numbers are easily customisable in the source code, the limit being the available memory and I/O pins.

System architecture

Transmitter hardware block diagram



Receiver hardware block diagram



RF protocol

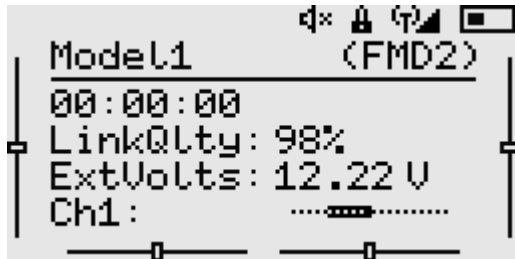
A custom RF protocol is used to communicate between the transmitter and receiver. The implementation builds on top of LoRa(R) transceivers. The documentation can be found in the Protocols folder.

The main features are:-

- 10 bit encoding for all RC channels
- 50 Hz update rate for all RC channels
- Frequency Hopping Spread Spectrum
- Telemetry support

Home screen

The home screen is the default screen shown when operating the transmitter. It displays basic information such as the active model name, trims, status icons, transmitter battery, active flight mode, and up to four custom widgets.



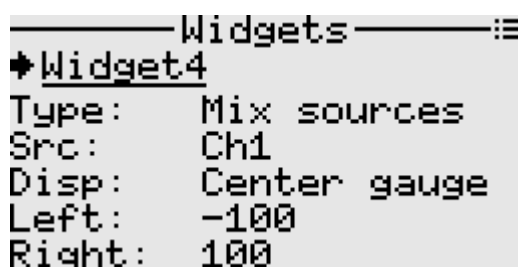
Key actions on the home screen are as follows:

- Down key
 - Click: Opens the context menu.
 - Hold: Quickly mutes/unmutes telemetry alarms.
- Up key
 - Click: Opens the channel monitor.
 - Hold: Enters the on-screen trim mode on handsets that lack physical trim buttons.
- Select Key
 - Click: Opens the main menu.
 - Hold: Navigate back. This is also the default behaviour in all screens.

Widgets

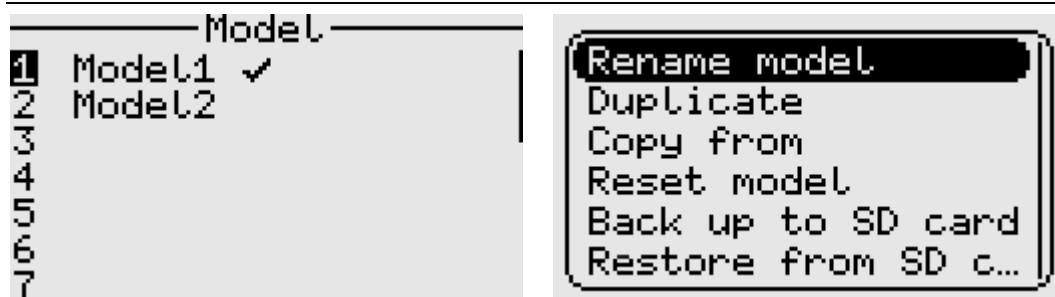
Customizable widgets allow the user to display/monitor different parameters directly on the home screen.

To set up the widgets, access the home screen context menu.



- **Type:** The category of widget, i.e. Telemetry, Mix sources, Outputs, Timers, or Counters.
- **Source:** The input source for the widget.
- **Display:** Specifies how the widget is shown on the home screen, i.e. as a numerical value, a gauge, or a zero-centered gauge. Available options depend on the type of widget selected.
- **Minimum and Maximum:** Sets the lower and upper limits of the gauge.

Model manager



The model manager enables various actions, such as creating, loading, and deleting models. By default, model settings are stored in the EEPROM.

SD cards are also supported and are useful for backing up and restoring models. Model data on the SD card is stored in a human-readable text format similar to YAML.

Available model types

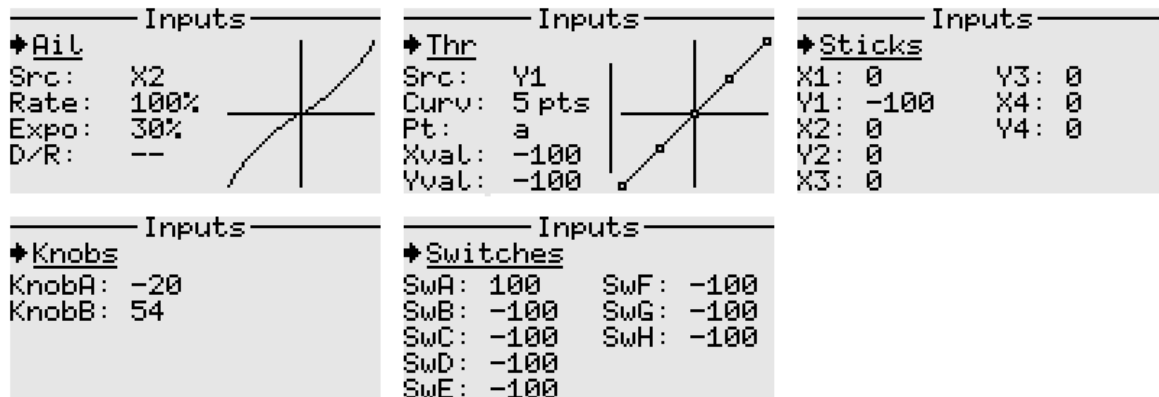
- Airplane: Used for fixed wing aircraft.
- Multicopter: Used for aircraft with rotors, e.g. quadcopters, helicopters, etc.
- Other: This is a generic type for anything else. Boats, land vehicles, robots, animatronics, etc.

Note:

1. An external EEPROM is recommended but not mandatory. However, without it, the system will only have one model slot available, which makes it cumbersome to switch between different models, as we would always need to rely on the SD card to load a different model.
2. Before updating the firmware in the transmitter, always back up your models to the SD card to avoid any potential data loss or corruption.
3. The "Copy from" feature only works between models of the same type.
4. Loading or selecting a new model disables RF output for safety reasons; therefore, RF output must be manually re-enabled afterward.

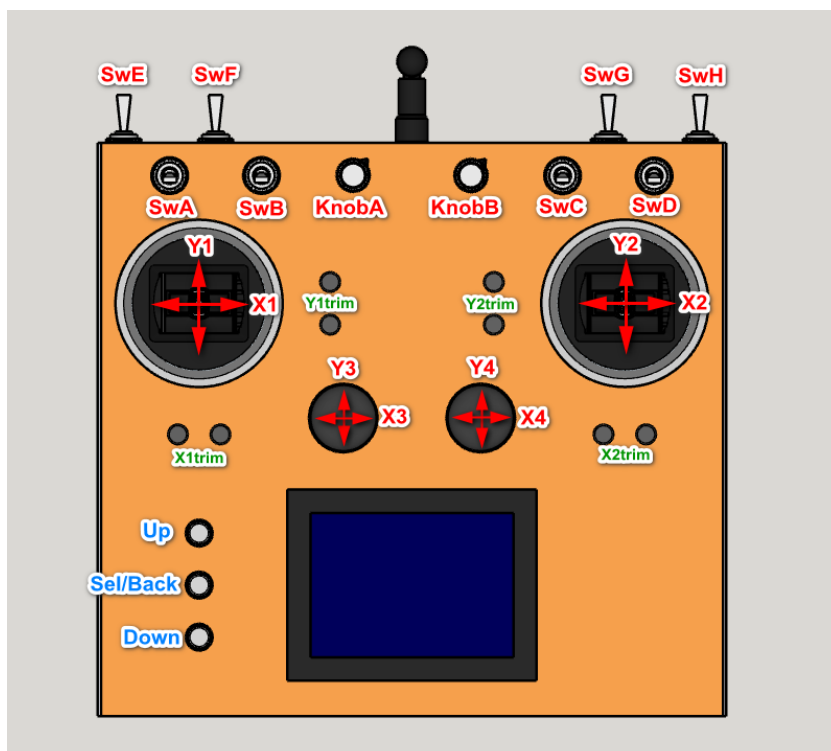
Inputs

The inputs screen allows setting dual rates and expo, throttle curve, as well as showing the values from the physical controls.



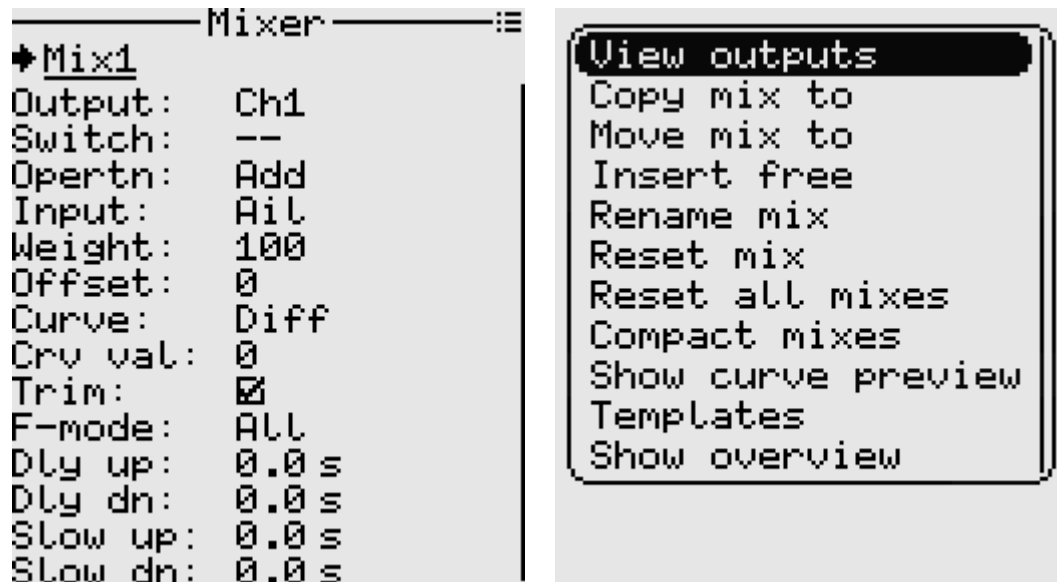
- For model type 'Airplane', the naming used for the main controls is Ail, Ele, Rud, Thr.
- For model type 'Multicopter', the nomenclature changes to Roll, Pitch, Yaw, Thr.
- The sources for the above inputs may default to a different order based on the chosen stick mode in System settings.
- The system accepts both 2-position and 3-position switches, as well as their momentary variants.

The image below shows a typical layout of the transmitter.



The Mixer

The mixer is where the inputs (mixer sources) get linked to the output channels (servos, etc.). This controller features a mixer system that draws inspiration from that found in OpenTX(R) based RC transmitters, though not directly compatible.



Mixer fields

- **Output:** The channel that is to be affected by the mix. If none, the mix is inactive and is not computed.
- **Switch:** The control switch to turn the mix on or off. The mix is always active if no switch is specified.
- **Operation:** Add, Multiply, Replace, Hold.
- **Input:** This is the mixer source.
- **Weight:** Determines how much of an effect the input has on the output. -100 to 100.
- **Offset:** The input is offset by this value after the weight has been applied. -100 to 100.
- **Curve:** Differential, Expo, Function, Custom curve.
- **Curve value:** Differential {-100 to 100}, Expo {-100 to 100}, Function { $x > 0$, $x < 0$, $|x|$ }, Curve name if custom curve.
- **Trim:** Whether to add trim or not.
- **F-Mode:** The flight mode in which the mix applies.
- **Delay Up and Down:** This is used to delay the input. 0 to 60 seconds.
- **Slow Up and Down:** This when non-zero specifies how fast the input changes. 0 to 60 seconds.

Mixer sources

Mixer sources can be any of the following:

- Raw stick axes (X1, Y1, X2, Y2, etc.)
- Processed sticks (Rud/Yaw, Thr, Ail/Roll, Ele/Pitch)
- Knobs (KnobA, KnobB)
- Constants (Max)
- Function generators (Fgen1, Fgen2, etc.)
- Trims (X1Trim, Y1Trim, X2Trim, Y2Trim)
- Physical switches (SwA, SwB, etc.)
- Logical switches (L1, L2, etc.)
- Channels (Ch1, Ch2, etc.)
- Virtual channels (Virt1, Virt2, etc.)

Counters can also be used as inputs in the mixer, although they are not classified as true mixer sources.

Control switches

These can be used to activate or deactivate various functions, for example enabling or disabling mixes, starting or stopping timers, and more. The following control switches are available:

- Physical switches (SwA $\uparrow$, SwA $-$, SwA $\downarrow$, etc.)
- Logical switches (L1, L2, !L1, !L2, etc.)
- Trim buttons (X1Trim $\leftarrow$, X1Trim $\rightarrow$, Y1Trim $\uparrow$, Y1Trim $\downarrow$, etc.)
- Flight modes as control switches (Fmd1, Fmd2, !Fmd1, !Fmd2, etc.)

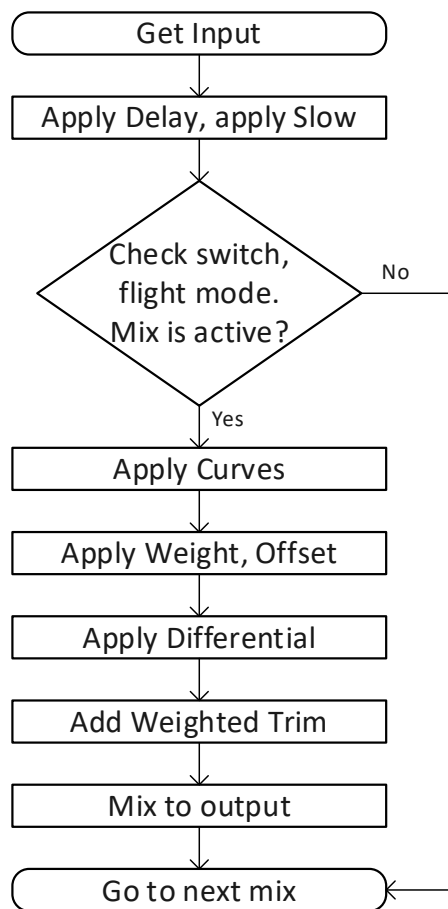
The symbols " $\uparrow$ ", " $-$ ", and " $\downarrow$ " correspond to the up, middle (center), and down positions of physical switches, respectively.

The " $\uparrow$ " and " $\downarrow$ " symbols are also used on vertical trim buttons to indicate an active upward or downward press.

The " $\leftarrow$ ", and " $\rightarrow$ " symbols also denote the left and right press states of the horizontal trim buttons.

The "!" symbol indicates a logical NOT operator. For example, the condition "!SwC $\uparrow$ " evaluates as true when SwC is not in the up position.

Order of mixer operations



Context menu actions

- **View outputs:** Opens the mixer monitor, which shows the real-time status of all output channels. Click the Select button within this monitor to view a tooltip containing the exact value of the selected channel.
- **Copy mix to:** Copies this mix to a specified destination.
- **Move mix to:** Moves this mix to a specified destination.
- **Insert free:** Inserts a free mix slot at the current position.
- **Rename mix:** Opens the text editor dialog to specify a name for this mix.
- **Reset mix:** Resets this mix to the default setting.
- **Reset all mixes:** Resets all mixes to the default settings.
- **Compact mixes:** Removes all empty/free slots that exist in-between the defined mixes.
- **Show curve preview:** Whether to draw the curve on the mixer screen. The displayed curve shows a trace of the output vs input for this specific mix.
- **Templates:** Use this option to load the predefined mixer templates.

- **Show overview:** Display a summary of the configured mixes. In the overview screen, click the Select button to display a tooltip with extra information about the highlighted mix line.

Important safety note

When editing mixes, it is recommended to disable RF output or remove propellers first. This is because all changes/adjustments made are applied instantly and may bring surprises.

Example mixes

Note:

- The convention used in these examples is negative for left/downward going control surfaces, positive for right/upward going control surfaces. For example, if the Ail stick is moved right, the left aileron moves down and the right aileron moves up. Hence, we use a negative weight for the left aileron and a positive weight for the right aileron.
- If a servo is moving in wrong direction, reversing the direction in Outputs screen solves this.
- The Mixer is all about control logic. Any mechanical differences should be handled in the Outputs screen and not inside the Mixer.

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- [2. Elevon](#)
- [3. Vtail](#)
- [4. Aileron differential](#)
- [5. Tailerons](#)
- [6. Flaperons](#)
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Example 1: Basic 4 channel

Assuming Aileron servo in Ch1, Elevator servo in Ch2, Throttle in Ch3, Rudder servo in Ch4

1. Ch1 Add Ail (Weight 100)
2. Ch2 Add Ele (Weight -100)
3. Ch3 Add Thr (Weight 100)
4. Ch4 Add Rud (Weight 100)

Example 2: Elevon

Left servo in Ch1, right servo in Ch2

1. Ch1 Add Ail (Weight -50)
2. Ch1 Add Ele (Weight -50)
3. Ch2 Add Ail (Weight 50)
4. Ch2 Add Ele (Weight -50)

Example 3: Vtail

Left servo in Ch2, right servo in Ch4

1. Ch2 Add Rud (Weight 50)
2. Ch2 Add Ele (Weight -50)
3. Ch4 Add Rud (Weight -50)
4. Ch4 Add Ele (Weight -50)

Example 4: Aileron differential

Left aileron in Ch1, right aileron in Ch8. We want the downward going aileron to get less displaced than the upward going aileron. Due to differences in lift and air pressure on the top and bottom wing surfaces, the aileron surface produces more drag when it moves down than when it moves up. This tends to cause an adverse yaw effect hence the need for aileron differential.

1. Ch1 Add Ail (Weight -100, Diff 30)
2. Ch8 Add Ail (Weight 100, Diff 30)

Example 5: Tailerons

Left Elevator servo in Ch6, Right Elevator servo in Ch7. The mix is turned on/off with SwG.

1. Ch6 Add Ele (Weight -60)
2. Ch6 Add Ail (Weight -40, Switch SwG_Down)
3. Ch7 Add Ele (Weight -60)
4. Ch7 Add Ail (Weight 40, Switch SwG_Down)

Example 6: Flaperons

Left aileron in Ch1, right aileron in Ch8. Using SwC to operate the flaperons. When SwC is in upper position, flaperons are off. In middle position half

flaperons, and in lower position full flaperons.
For smooth flaperon deployment, we use the slow up/down feature.

1. Ch1 Add Ail (Weight -100, Diff 30)
2. Ch1 Add SwC (Weight -40, Offset -40, SlowUp 1 s, SlowDown 1 s)
3. Ch8 Add Ail (Weight 100, Diff 30)
4. Ch8 Add SwC (Weight -40, Offset -40, SlowUp 1 s, SlowDown 1 s)

Example 7: Crow braking

Left ail servo in Ch1, Right Ail servo in Ch8, left flap servo in Ch5, right flap servo in Ch6.

Using the three position SwC for operation. Normal aileron action occurs when SwC is in upper or middle position. Half flaps are deployed when SwC is in middle position. When SwC is in lower position, both ailerons move upward and full flaps are deployed.

1. Ch1 Add Ail (Weight -100, Diff 30)
2. Ch1 Add SwC (Weight 60, Func x>0, SlowUp 1 s, SlowDown 1 s)
3. Ch8 Add Ail (Weight 100, Diff 30)
4. Ch8 Add SwC (Weight 60, Func x>0, SlowUp 1 s, SlowDown 1 s)
5. Ch5 Add SwC (Weight -50, Offset -50, SlowUp 1 s, SlowDown 1 s)
6. Ch6 Add Ch5 (Weight 100)

Example 8: Flaps working as ailerons

This mix allows the entire trailing edge of the wing (aileron and flap) to operate as ailerons. Assuming the left flap servo in Ch5, right flap servo in Ch6.

Using a two position switch e.g. SwD to switch between flap mode and aileron mode.

Using the three position SwC to set the flap position in flap mode.

1. Ch5 Add SwC (Weight -50, Offset -50)
2. Ch5 RplcW Ail (Weight -100, Diff 20, Switch SwD_Down)
3. Ch6 Add SwC (Weight -50, Offset -50)
4. Ch6 RplcW Ail (Weight 100, Diff 20, Switch SwD_Down)

Example 9: Differential thrust

Left motor in Ch3, right motor in Ch7. We can use a switch e.g. SwE to turn the differential thrust off while in the air. Also assume the Rud source is the X1 axis

1. Ch3 Add Thr (Weight 100)
2. Ch3 Add X1 (Weight 40, Switch SwE_Down)
3. Ch7 Add Thr (Weight 100)
4. Ch7 Add X1 (Weight -40, Switch SwE_Down)

For safety, we also need to set Failsafe for both Ch3 and Ch7 in the 'Outputs' screen.

We can also add throttle cut by specifying an override switch and a value of -100.

Example 10: Throttle elevator mixing

When the throttle is increased, some down elevator can be added to counteract the tendency of the model gaining altitude when the throttle increases.

1. Ch2 Add Ele (Weight -100)
2. Ch2 Add Thr (Weight -20, Offset -20)

Example 11: Variable steering depending on throttle position

We want the steering response to reduce with increasing throttle. Assuming we use the X1 axis to steer, Y1 axis as our throttle source, and the steering servo is on Ch6,

1. Ch6 Add X1 (Weight 100)
2. Ch6 Mltply Y1 (Weight -40, Offset 60)

Example 12: Adjust idle throttle with knob

Suppose we want to adjust the idle setting of the engine, without affecting full throttle. Assuming the throttle servo is in Ch3,

1. Ch3 Add KnobA (Weight 20, Offset 20)
2. Ch3 Mltply Thrt (Weight -50, Offset 50)
3. Ch3 Add Thrt (Weight 100)

Example 13: Adjust maximum throttle with knob

We can adjust the maximum throttle without affecting the low throttle setting. Assuming the motor is in Ch3,

1. Ch3 Add KnobA (Weight 20, Offset -20)
2. Ch3 Mltply Thrt (Weight 50, Offset 50)
3. Ch3 Add Thrt (Weight 100)

Example 14: Simple throttle cut

Assuming Ch3 is the throttle channel, and assigning SwA for cut. When SwA is in the up position, Ch3 is locked to -100, otherwise the Throttle input is sent to Ch3.

1. Ch3 Add Thrt (Weight 100)
2. Ch3 RplcW Max (Weight -100, Switch SwA_Up)

Alternatively, a much safer throttle cut can be achieved in the Outputs screen by specifying the override as SwA and value -100.

Example 15: Sticky throttle cut

Assuming Ch3 is the throttle channel, and assigning SwA for cut. Also assume our Throttle source is Y1 axis. We want the throttle cut whenever SwA is in the up position, but to only remove the cut when the throttle is at minimum and

SwA is in the down position.

This example makes use of logical switches as follows.

```
L1
Func:   Latch
Set:    SwA_Up
Reset:  L3

L2
Func:   a==x
Value1: Y1
Value2: -100

L3
Func:   AND
Value1: SwA_down
Value2: L2
```

Then in the mixer

```
1. Ch3 Add   Thrt (Weight 100)
2. Ch3 RplcW Max (Weight -100, Switch L1)
```

Alternatively, a much safer throttle cut can be achieved in the Outputs screen by specifying the override as L1 and value -100.

Example 16: Landing gear sequencer (gear doors stay open after gear is extended)

The sequence we want upon flicking the switch is: doors open, gear extends. Similarly in the opposite direction: gear retracts, doors close. Using SwD for operation and assuming gear doors on Ch6 and gear on Ch7.

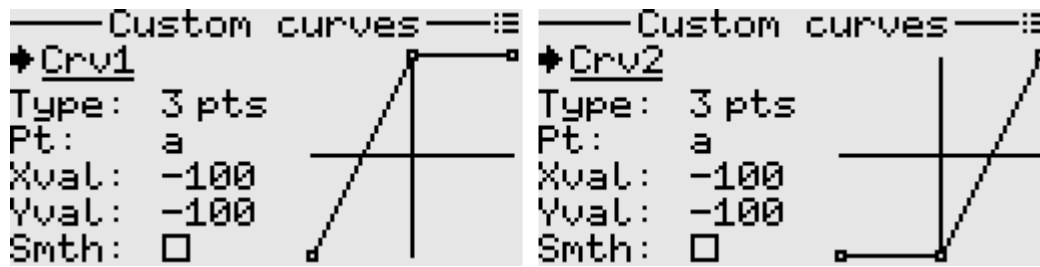
```
1. Ch6 Add SwD (Weight 100, DelayUp 0 s, DelayDown 3 s, SlowUp 2 s, SlowDown 2 s)
2. Ch7 Add SwD (Weight 100, DelayUp 3 s, DelayDown 0 s, SlowUp 2 s, SlowDown 2 s)
```

Alternative method that uses custom curves

Set up two custom curves as follows.

```
Curve1
Type: 3 point
Point(x,y): PtA(-100,-100) PtB(0,100) PtC(100,100)

Curve2
Type: 3 point
Point(x,y): PtA(-100,-100) PtB(0,-100) PtC(100,100)
```



Then in the mixer, assuming gear door servos on Ch7, gear servos on Ch8, and using SwD to operate,

```
//Create a source that slowly ramps
1. Virt1 Add SwD (Weight 100, SlowUp 5 s, SlowDown 5 s)

//Apply curve1 for the door sequence
2. Ch7 Add Virt1 (Weight 100, Custom Curve1)

//Apply curve2 for the gear sequence
3. Ch8 Add Virt1 (Weight 100, Custom Curve2)
```

Example 17: Landing gear sequencer (gear doors close after gear is extended)

The extend sequence is doors open, gear is lowered, doors close.

The retract sequence is doors open, gear retracts, doors close.

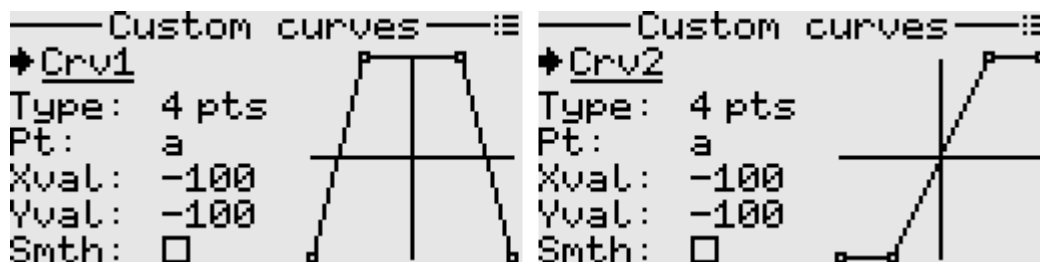
We can achieve the above using custom curves in combination with a slowed switch.

Servo version

Set up two custom curves as follows.

```
Curve1
Type: 4 point
Point(x,y): PtA(-100,-100) PtB(-50,100) PtC(50,100) PtD(100,-100)

Curve2
Type: 4 point
Point(x,y): PtA(-100,-100) PtB(-50,-100) PtC(50,100) PtD(100,100)
```



Then in the mixer, assuming gear door servos on Ch7, gear servos on Ch8, and using SwD to operate,

```
//Create a source that slowly ramps
1. Virt1 Add SwD (Weight 100, SlowUp 7 s, SlowDown 7 s)

//Apply curve1 for the door sequence
2. Ch7 Add Virt1 (Weight 100, Custom Curve1)

//Apply curve2 for the gear sequence
3. Ch8 Add Virt1 (Weight 100, Custom Curve2)
```

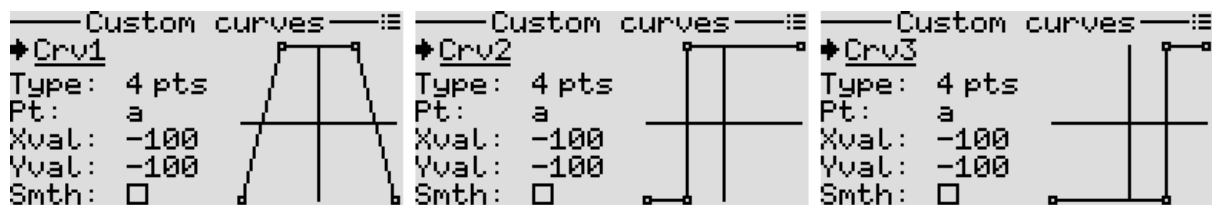
Retract actuator version

Most electric retract actuators require an on/off control signal, so this example is designed to work with these.
Set up three custom curves as follows.

```
Curve1
Type: 4 point
Point(x,y): PtA(-100,-100) PtB(-50,100) PtC(50,100) PtD(100,-100)

Curve2
Type: 4 point
Point(x,y): PtA(-100,-100) PtB(-50,-100) PtC(-50,100) PtD(100,100)

Curve3
Type: 4 point
Point(x,y): PtA(-100,-100) PtB(50,-100) PtC(50,100) PtD(100,100)
```



Then in the mixer, assuming gear door servos on Ch7, gear retracts on Ch8, and using SwD to operate,

```
//Create a source that slowly ramps
1. Virt1 Add SwD (Weight 100, SlowUp 10 s, SlowDown 10 s)

//Apply curve1 for the door sequence
2. Ch7 Add Virt1 (Weight 100, Custom Curve1)

//Apply curve2 for the gear extend sequence
3. Ch8 Add Virt1 (Weight 100, Custom Curve2)

//Apply curve3 for the gear retract sequence
4. Ch8 RplcW Virt1 (Weight 100, Custom Curve3, Switch SwD_Up)
```

We can, if necessary, set Ch8 to 'Digital' mode in the receiver output configuration screen.

Example 18: Servo tester

We can program a simple servo tester that repeatedly moves a servo back and forth.

In the Extras menu, navigate to Function generator and select the desired movement type.

Then in the mixer, assuming the servo is connected to Ch8,

```
1. Ch8  Add  Fgen1 (Weight 100)
```

We can also make it more interesting by adding the ability to switch between waveforms or patterns via a switch. This is left as an exercise.

Example 19: Random servo motion generator

Suppose we have a model equipped with a turret, or a figure. We want the servo to move automatically but in a random and intermittent manner.

We can achieve this with function generators and logical switches as follows.

```
Fgen1  
Waveform: Random  
Interval: 2.0 s
```

```
Fgen2  
Waveform: Random  
Interval: 1.3 s
```

```
L1  
Func:    a>x  
Value1:  Fgen2  
Value2:  0
```

Then in the mixer, assuming our servo is on Ch7,

```
1. Ch7  Add  Fgen1 (Weight 100)  
2. Ch7  Hold          (Switch L1)  
3. Ch7  RplcW Ch7  (Weight 100, SlowUp 2 s, SlowDown 2 s)
```

Explanation:

Fgen1 generates a random position periodically, Fgen2 via Logical switch L1 is used to hold the output randomly to create the impression of intermittent motion. The last mixer line helps smooth the movement.

If desired, we can also incorporate a custom curve to sort of bias the generated servo positions, for example if we want our turret be pointing around the middle most of the time.

We can also easily modify the setup to include an extra switch to manually stop the motion.

Example 20: Random servo motion generator (advanced version)

This example generates a random servo position at a random interval, with an added effect of random intermittency, and random selection between two speeds.

Furthermore, a physical switch SwE is used to start/stop the random motion of the servo.

```
Fgen1
Waveform:      Random
Interval mode: Variable
Min Interval:  1.0 s
Max Interval:  2.0 s
Modulator:     Fgen2

Fgen2 (modulates the interval of Fgen1)
Waveform:      Random
Interval mode: Fixed
Interval:      1.0 s

Fgen3 (used for the intermittent motion)
Waveform:      Random
Interval mode: Fixed
Interval:      1.0 s

Fgen4 (used for the selection between two speeds)
Waveform:      Random
Interval mode: Fixed
Interval:      2.0 s
```

Then set up two logical switches as follows.

```
L1
Func:  a>x
Value1: Fgen3
Value2: 0

L2
Func:  a>x
Value1: Fgen4
Value2: 0
```

Then in the mixer, assuming our servo is on Ch7,

```
1. Ch7  Add    Fgen1 (Weight 100)
2. Ch7  Hold           (Switch L1)
3. Ch7  RplcW  Max    (Weight 0, SwE_Up)
```

4. Ch7 RplcW Ch7 (Weight 100, SlowUp 5 s, SlowDown 5 s, Switch L2)
5. Ch7 RplcW Ch7 (Weight 100, SlowUp 2 s, SlowDown 2 s)

Example 21: Oscillation without using the built-in function generator

Here is a way to create a crude oscillator from scratch.

Set up a custom curve that defines the shape of our arbitrary waveform. For example,

```
Curve1
Type: 5 point
Point(x,y): PtA(-100,0) PtB(-50,-100) PtC(0,0) PtD(50,100), PtE(100,0)
Smooth: True
```

Then define a logical switch as follows.

```
L1
Func: a<x
Value1: Virt1
Value2: 100
```

Then in the mixer, we make use of the 'slow' feature on the L1 mixer input. This essentially creates a sawtooth waveform on Virt1. Assuming our final output is on Ch1, we specify the input as Virt1 and apply the custom curve.

1. Virt1 Add L1 (Weight 100, SlowUp 1 s, SlowDown 0 s)
2. Ch1 Add Virt1 (Weight 100, Custom Curve1)

Example 22: Aileron rudder mixing with automatic switching

When the Rudder stick is centered and the Aileron stick is moved away from center, the mix is activated (Aileron stick now controls the rudder).

The mix is deactivated as soon as the Rudder stick is moved away from center (Rudder stick now controls the Rudder).

When both sticks are centered the mix gets activated again.

We can achieve this behaviour with the help of logical switches as follows.

```
L1
Func: a==x
Value1: Rud
Value2: 0

L2
Func: a==x
Value1: Ail
Value2: 0
```

```
L3
Func:   AND
Value1: L1
Value2: L2
```

```
L4
Func:   Latch
Set:    L3
Reset:  !L1
```

Then in the mixer, assuming the rudder servo is on Ch4,

```
1. Virt1 Add      Max    (Weight 100, Switch L4)
2. Ch4   Add      Ail    (Weight 100, No trim)
3. Ch4   Mltply   Virt1  (Weight 100, SlowDown 1 s)
4. Ch4   Add      Rud    (Weight 100)
```

Here, Virt1 is used to smooth the transition from the Aileron stick to the Rudder stick.

Example 23: Adjust aileron differential with the knob

This example illustrates a method for adjusting aileron differential in-flight, eliminating the need to land whenever we want to tweak the setting. It is quite handy for experimenting with different values and helping with fine tuning. As we rotate the knob clockwise, the differential increases from 0% to 100%. Set up a logical switch as follows.

```
L1
Func:   a>x
Value1: Ail
Value2: 0
```

Then in the mixer, assuming the left aileron servo in Ch1, right in Ch8,

```
1. Ch1   Add      Ail    (Weight -100, No trim)
2. Ch1   Mltply   KnobB  (Weight -50, Offset 50, Switch L1)
3. Ch1   Add      X2Trim (Weight -100)
4. Ch8   Add      Ail    (Weight 100, No trim)
5. Ch8   Mltply   KnobB  (Weight -50, Offset 50, Switch !L1)
6. Ch8   Add      X2Trim (Weight 100)
```

Explanation:

Differential is applied to the downward going aileron. When the Ail stick is moved right, we apply differential to the left aileron. Similarly, when the Ail stick is moved left, we apply differential to the right aileron.

We detect the direction of the Ail stick via the logical switch L1 and use it to selectively apply the differential effect via a multiply mix.

For this case, we also decouple the trim and add it afterward, to prevent it being affected by the differential.

Outputs

Outputs are the last stage of the processing chain (Inputs ---> Mixer ---> Outputs).

It is where final adjustments to the control data are made before transmission to the receiver.

Outputs			Outputs		
✦ Ch1			Ch1: -100	Ch6: 0.0	
Reverse: ☐			Ch2: 100	Ch7: 0.0	
Subtrim: 0.0			Ch3: -100	Ch8: 0.0	
Override: --	--		Ch4: -100	Ch9: 0.0	
Failsafe: Hold			Ch5: 0.0	Ch10: 0.0	
Endpts: -100	100				
Curve: None					

- **Reverse:** Useful for correcting the servo or actuator direction relative to the controls.
- **Subtrim:** Adjusts the center position of the servo or actuator. A side effect of using subtrim is that it causes clipping at the ends. E.g. if the mixer is outputting -100 to 100, a subtrim of say +5 shifts the usable range of the servo to -95 to 100.
- **Override:** This is mainly a safety feature used for throttle cut, etc. It overrides the channel's output with the specified value when the activation switch is on.
- **Failsafe:** The receiver will output the specified value after about 1 second of signal loss from the transmitter. Supported modes are Hold, No pulse, or Custom value.
 - Hold - The receiver continues outputting the last value received prior to signal loss.
 - No pulse - The receiver stops outputting pulses when signal loss occurs.
 - Custom value - The receiver outputs a user-defined preset value.

Always ensure that the correct failsafe setting is being used for the respective channel, especially for channels controlling motors or engines.

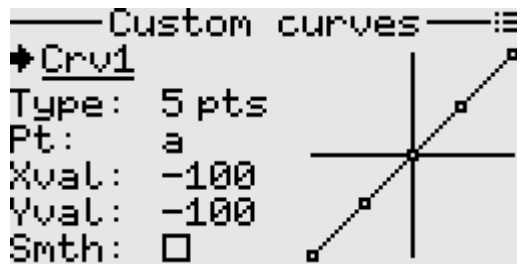
- **Endpoints:** Sets the overall travel or endpoints of the servo arm movement. Useful when we want to avoid any potential binding of a linkage or surface.
- **Curve:** Specifies the custom curve to use for this output. Useful when we want to correct for linkage geometry, mechanical differences, etc.

Custom curves

These can be used in the mixer and the outputs screen. They basically define a relation between an input (along the x) and output (along the y).

Any point/node on the curve can be freely moved around to get the desired shape of curve. Up to 10 points/nodes can be defined.

The curve can also be optionally smoothed, although this feature should be used sparingly as it is relatively CPU intensive.



Combining two curves for extra points or nodes

If more curve points are needed, a work around is to combine two curves by switching out one for the other in the mixer, with help of a logical switch.

Usage examples

Below are some examples demonstrating the use of custom curves.

- [Landing gear sequencer](#)
- [Landing gear sequencer - advanced](#)
- [Oscillator from scratch](#)

Logical switches

These can be used to combine various conditions, compare values, etc. They are in essence user programmed virtual switches. They produce an on/off output.

```
— Logical switches —
+ L1
Functn:  a>x
Value1:  --
Value2:  0
Delay:   --
Duratn:  --
```

The available functions can be categorized into the following types.

- Comparators (Greater than, Less than, Equal, Greater than or equal, Less than or equal)
- Combinational (AND, OR, XOR)
- Latches (SR latch)
- Flip-flops (Toggle)
- Generators (Pulse)

Usage examples

- [1. A mix activated by combination of two switches](#)
- [2. LED lights that flash when flight battery is low](#)
- [3. Stopwatch operated by a single momentary switch](#)
- [4. Throttle timer - simple](#)
- [5. Throttle timer - advanced](#)
- [6. Zero crossing detection](#)
- [7. Using a momentary switch to cycle among values](#)
- [8. Detecting receiver connection or disconnection](#)

Example 1: A mix activated by combination of two switches

Suppose we want a mix to be turned on only when two switches (e.g. SwA, SwB) are both on. We need to set up a logical switch say L1 as follows.

```
L1
Functn: AND
Value1: SwA_down
Value2: SwB_down
```

Then in the mixer, we simply have to set the control switch to L1.

Example 2: LED lights that flash when flight battery is low

Suppose we have a model that is equipped with some LED lights that we want to switch on when the flight battery voltage (telemetry) falls below a certain threshold for more than say five seconds.

We can easily achieve this like so.

```
L1
Functn: a<x
Value1: FlightBatt
Value2: 10.80 V
Delay: 5.0 s

L2
Functn: Pulse
Width: 1.0 s
Period: 2.0 s
```

Then in the mixer, we simply use L2 as the input source and L1 as the control switch for the mix, to operate the channel assigned to the LED lights.

Example 3: Stopwatch operated by a single momentary switch for start/stop and reset

When the switch is clicked, the timer runs/stops. When the switch is held long enough, the timer is reset.

For this, we set up two logical switches to operate the timer as below, assuming SwH is our momentary switch.

```
L1
Functn: Toggle
Clock: SwH_down
Edge: Falling
Clear: L2

L2
Functn: a>x
Value1: SwH
Value2: 0
Delay: 0.5 s

Timer1
Switch: L1
Reset: L2
```

Explanation:

The output of L1 toggles whenever SwH is released. L1 is then used to run/stop the timer.

L2 goes high when SwH is down for more than 0.5 seconds, providing a signal for resetting the timer. L2 is also used to clear the state of L1 such that resetting the timer does not falsely trigger it to run on releasing the switch.

Example 4: Throttle timer (simple)

When the throttle is moved beyond a certain threshold, the timer runs.

Also if we have a throttle cut function on say SwA, we want the timer to only run when throttle cut is inactive.

Assume the throttle source is the Y1 axis.

```
L1
Functn: a>x
Value1: Y1
Value2: -90

L2
Functn: AND
Value1: L1
Value2: SwA_down

Timer1
Switch: L2
```

Example 5: Throttle timer (advanced)

Suppose we want the speed at which the timer runs to be proportional to the throttle value.

Also if we have a throttle cut function on say SwA, we want the timer to only run when throttle cut is inactive.

Assume our throttle source is the Y1 axis.

Method 1:

Using the built-in function generator to generate a pulse width modulated signal that controls the timer.

```
Fgen1
Waveform: Pulse
Width mode: Variable
Modulator: Y1
Reverse: False
Period: 1.0 s

L1
Functn: a>x
Value1: Fgen1
Value2: 0
```

```
L2
Functn: AND
Value1: L1
Value2: SwA_down
```

```
Timer1
Switch: L2
```

Explanation:

The throttle source (Y1 axis) is used to modulate the pulse width of the generated pulse waveform. Since the timer only accepts signals from control switches, we need to convert the output from the function generator. This is done via L1. When SwA is in the down position, the resulting signal is passed to the timer to control it.

Method 2:

Using the mixer and a virtual channel to create a pulse width modulated signal that controls the timer.

```
Mixer
1. Virt1 Add L1 (Weight 99, SlowUp 0.5 s, SlowDown 0.5 s)
```

```
L1
Functn: Pulse
Width: 0.5 s
Period: 1.0 s
```

```
L2
Functn: a>b
Value1: Y1
Value2: Virt1
```

```
L3
Functn: AND
Value1: L2
Value2: SwA_down
```

```
Timer1
Switch: L3
```

Explanation:

L1 and Virt1 effectively create a triangle waveform, which gets compared with the value of the throttle source (Y1 axis) via L2. When SwA is in the down position, the resulting signal is passed to the timer to control it.

If desired, we can also include a custom curve through a virtual channel, to compensate for the real-world nonlinear relationship between current draw and throttle value.

Example 6: Zero crossing detection

Suppose we want to detect whenever a value from say a function generator crosses zero, so that we can trigger some other action.

```
L1
Functn: a>=x
Value1: Fgen1
Value2: 0

L2
Functn: |delta|>x
Value1: L1
Value2: 0
Direction: Both
```

L2 will now output a brief pulse whenever the output of the function generator crosses zero.

Example 7: Using a momentary switch to cycle among four values or states

Suppose we want an output channel to cycle among four levels whenever we click the momentary switch.

Method 1:

Set up a '2-bit' binary counter with its outputs on L2 and L1 as follows.

```
L1
Functn: Toggle
Clock: SwH_down
Edge: Rising

L2
Functn: Toggle
Clock: L1
Edge: Falling
```

Use a truth table to set up logical switches L3, L4, L5, and L6

L2	L1	
0	0	L3
0	1	L4
1	0	L5
1	1	L6

```
L3
Functn: AND
Value1: !L2
```

Value2: !L1

L4

Functn: AND

Value1: !L2

Value2: L1

L5

Functn: AND

Value1: L2

Value2: !L1

L6

Functn: AND

Value1: L2

Value2: L1

Then in the Mixer,

1.	Ch1	RplcW	Max	(Weight -100,	Switch L3)
2.	Ch1	RplcW	Max	(weight -33,	Switch L4)
3.	Ch1	RplcW	Max	(weight 33,	Switch L5)
4.	Ch1	RplcW	Max	(weight 100,	Switch L6)

Method 2:

This makes use of the built-in counter as follows.

Counter1

Clock: SwH_down

Edge: Rising

Modulus: 4

Direction: Up

L3

Functn: a==x

Value1: Counter1

Value2: 0

L4

Functn: a==x

Value1: Counter1

Value2: 1

L5

Functn: a==x

```
Value1: Counter1  
Value2: 2
```

```
L6  
Functn: a==x  
Value1: Counter1  
Value2: 3
```

Then in the Mixer,

```
1. Ch1 RplcW Max (Weight -100, Switch L3)  
2. Ch1 RplcW Max (weight -33, Switch L4)  
3. Ch1 RplcW Max (weight 33, Switch L5)  
4. Ch1 RplcW Max (weight 100, Switch L6)
```

Method 3:

This makes use of the built-in counter directly in the Mixer. [See the example](#) under counters.

Example 8: Detecting receiver connection or disconnection

This relies on the Link Quality telemetry to detect connection/disconnection of a receiver.

First, configure the Link Quality telemetry (premade template already available). Then set up a logical switch and custom notifications as follows.

```
L1  
Functn: a>x  
Value1: LinkQlty  
Value2: 0  
  
Notification1  
Switch: L1  
Tone: (Your preferred tone)  
Text: RX connect  
  
Notification2  
Switch: !L1  
Tone: (Your preferred tone)  
Text: RX disconnect
```

This example can also be adapted to detect when telemetry from a sensor is lost or recovered.

Function generators

These produce various waveforms over a range of frequencies or periods. They are implemented as low frequency oscillators, hence the reason why period instead of frequency is specifiable.

Supported waveforms are sine, square, triangle, sawtooth, pulse, and random. The function generators are capable of frequency modulation, with smooth transition between frequencies.

```
—Functn generators-≡
*Fgen1
Waveform:      Sine
Period mode:   Fixed
Period:        1.0 s
Phase mode:    Auto
Phase:         [Sync]
```

```
—Functn generators-≡
*Fgen1
Waveform:      Sine
Period mode:   Variable
Min period:    1.0 s
Max period:    2.0 s
Modulator:     None
Reverse:       ☐
```

Usage examples

Below are some examples making use of function generators.

- [Servo tester](#)
- [Random servo motion generator](#)
- [Random servo motion generator - advanced](#)

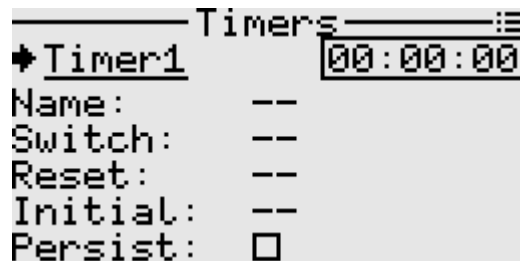
Timers

Timers are used to time events, etc. The system provides up to 3 programmable timers.

Timers can be configured to count up or count down.

In count down mode, an audible alarm is played when the timer reaches zero.

The timer continues to count with a negative sign.



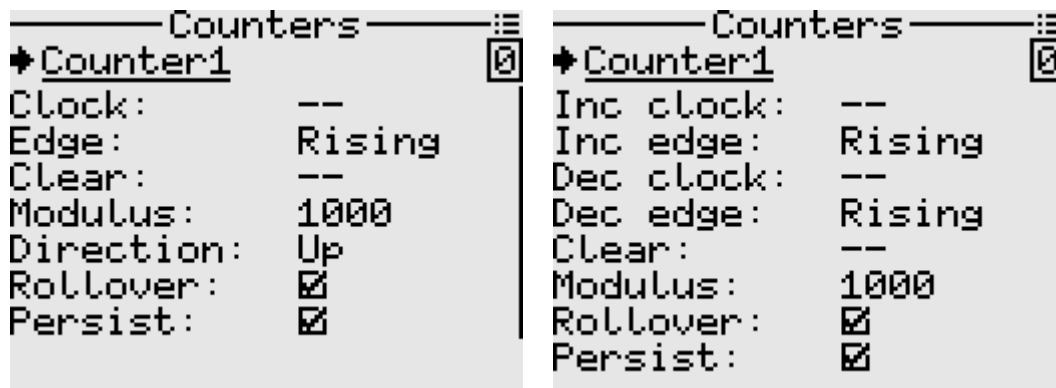
- **Name:** A name for the timer, otherwise a generic name is used.
- **Switch:** The control switch used to start and stop the timer. This is optional, as the timer can also be started or stopped from the context menu.
- **Reset:** The control switch used to reset the timer. This is optional, as the timer can also be reset from the context menu.
- **Initial:** The initial time if a countdown timer. If not specified, the timer will count up. A time picker dialog is used to easily set the initial time.
- **Persist:** Whether the timer is persistent i.e. if the value should be remembered between sessions.

Examples

- [Stopwatch operated by a single momentary switch](#)
- [Throttle timer - simple](#)
- [Throttle timer - advanced](#)

Counters

A counter stores and shows the number of times a particular event has occurred, in relationship to a clock signal.



- **Clock:** The control switch that triggers the counter.
- **Edge:** Rising, Falling, or Dual edge triggering. Applies to the clock signal.
- **Clear:** The control switch that clears the counter register to zero.
- **Modulus:** The number of states in its count sequence. E.g. mod 4 produces the sequence 0, 1, 2, 3.
- **Direction:** Determines whether counts will increment or decrement.
- **Rollover:** Rolls back over to start counting again from zero.
- **Persist:** Whether to remember the value in the counter's register between sessions.

In advanced mode, the counter behaves as an up/down counter using separate "up" and "down" clocks for increment and decrement respectively.

Usage examples

- [1. Using a 3 position momentary switch to sequentially select among values](#)
- [2. Using a 3 position momentary switch to continuously adjust a value](#)

Example 1: Using a 3 position momentary switch to sequentially select among values

This example demonstrates use of the counter directly inside the mixer. When the momentary switch is pushed in the downward direction, the counter value increments. Similarly, pushing the momentary switch in the opposite direction decrements the counter value.

In the counter screen context menu, change the counter type to advanced. Assuming SwG is our 3 position momentary switch, set up the counter as follows.

```
Counter1
Inc clock: SwG_down
```

```
Inc edge:   Rising
Dec clock:  SwG_up
Dec edge:   Rising
Modulus:    4
Rollover:   False
```

Then in the Mixer,

1. Ch1 Add Counter1 (Weight 100)

Note: The mixer automatically maps the counter's value in proportion to the counter's modulus.

For example if the modulus is 4, then mapping is {(0,-100), (1,-33), (2,33), (3,100)}.

Example 2: Using a 3 position momentary switch to continuously adjust a value

When the switch is pushed in one direction, the counter continuously increments until the switch is released. Similarly, the counter continuously decrements when the switch is pushed in the opposite direction.

For this, we set up some logical switches, like so.

```
L1
Functn: AND
Value1: !L1
Value2: SwG_down

L2
Functn: AND
Value1: !L2
Value2: SwG_up
```

In the above, we are essentially creating ring oscillators, though with only a single NOT stage.

This exploits the fact that the main program loop runs at about 50 times per second, thus we generate oscillations of about 25 Hz frequency.

We then use L1 and L2 to clock the counter as follows.

```
Counter1
Inc clock:  L1
Inc edge:   Rising
Dec clock:  L2
Dec edge:   Rising
Modulus:    100
Rollover:   False
```

Here, the modulus can be any value. For example, if the modulus is 100, it will take 4 seconds (=100/25) to increment from 0 to 99.

We then use the counter as input inside the Mixer like follows.

1. Ch1 Add Counter1 (Weight 100)

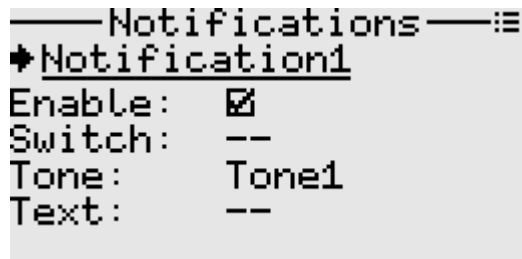
The mixer automatically maps the counter's value in proportion to the counter's modulus, to the range -100 to 100.

We can also specify some "slow up/down" of 4 seconds in the mixer to smooth the output.

Alternatively, we can adapt this example to use a self-centering stick axis like X4, instead of the momentary switch.

Notifications

Notifications are user-programmable and provide audible alarms to report about events.



- **Enable:** Whether the notification is enabled or disabled. Only enabled notifications will be sounded and displayed.
- **Switch:** The control switch used to trigger the notification. The notification gets only triggered on the positive going edge, i.e. when the state of the switch changes from low to high.
- **Tone:** The tune to play when the notification is triggered.
- **Text:** Optional text that will be displayed, as a toast message on the screen.

Note:

System events like low transmitter battery, inactivity, etc. are natively handled by the system, thus there is no need to configure them inside custom notifications.

Usage examples

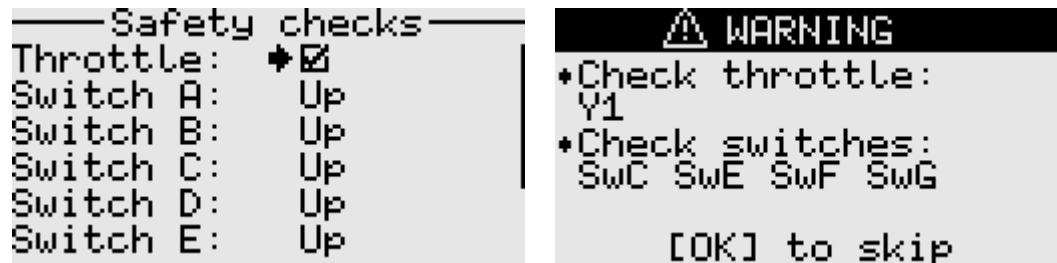
- [Detecting receiver connection or disconnection](#)

Safety checks

These checks are done before loading a model and on start up.

Positions of switches as well as the throttle source are checked, depending on the setting.

A warning will be shown if the set conditions are not met.



Trim setup

```
Trim setup
X1*: *Common (0.6)
Y1*: Off (0.0)
X2*: F-mode (-0.4)
Y2*: Common (-2.0)
Step: Fine
```

Available states are as follows.

- **Common:** Applies the same trim value across all flight modes.
- **F-mode:** Applies independent trim settings for each flight mode.
- **Off:** Trim is disabled globally for this axis, for example when we do not want trim on the throttle.

The Step setting determines how fast and how fine the trims move. Available options are Coarse, Medium, and Fine.

Flight modes

Flight modes allow you to easily reconfigure settings such as mixes and trim values with the simple flip of a switch. While it's possible to achieve similar adjustments using multiple switches, having the ability to make all these changes with just one switch is undoubtedly more efficient and convenient.

```
-----Flight modes-----
*Fmd1
Name:      --
Switch:    N/A
Fade-in:   1.0 s
```

- **Name:** A name/label for this flight mode.
- **Switch:** The control switch that activates this flight mode.
- **Fade-in:** The transition time to effect the trim setting for this flight mode.

Telemetry

```
-----Telemetry-----
■ GNSS/GPS: No data
  ■ LinkQlty: 98%
  ■ RSSI:      -65 dBm
  ■ ExtVolts: 12.22 V
  ■
  ■
```

General telemetry

The receiver has built-in basic telemetry i.e. external voltage, RSSI, and packet rate. To measure other parameters, you will have to build custom sensors and extend the receiver firmware to support these.

Telemetry values are transmitted as 16-bit signed integers.

To quickly mute/unmute telemetry alarms, long press the Down key on the home screen.

```
-----Sensor-----
Name:      ♦ExtVolts
Units:      V
ID:         0x01
Factor10:   -2
Multplr:    1.00
Offset:     0.00
Alerts:     <Threshold
Threshold:  10.65 V
On home:    [x]
RecordMax:  [x]
RecordMin:  [x]
```

- **Name:** The sensor name.
- **Units:** The units of measurement.
- **ID:** This is the sensor ID, which must be unique. However, the same ID can be used for example to display a value in multiple ways.
- **Factor10:** The raw value is multiplied by 10 to power this factor. Useful when we want to scale the value.
- **Multiplier:** The raw value is multiplied by this number. Useful when we want to scale the value.
- **Alerts:** This parameter specifies how the alarm behaves.
- **Threshold:** This is the value below or above which the telemetry alarm will be sounded. The telemetry value will also flash when in alarm state.
- **On home:** Whether to automatically show the telemetry sensor on the home screen.
- **Record max, and record min:** Whether to track the max/min values received from the sensor. Useful for simple stats. Note that max and min

are sensitive to outliers hence the filtering and smoothing should be done before sending the telemetry to the transmitter.

GNSS telemetry

GNSS telemetry is also supported. A premade template is used to add the GNSS sensor to the telemetry screen.

The receiver directly connects to the GNSS/GPS module via serial (UART), and handles parsing of the NMEA sentences as well as data conversion. GPS, GLONASS, BeiDou, Galileo are supported.

The system remembers the last known location in case of a lost model, even when the transmitter is powered off.

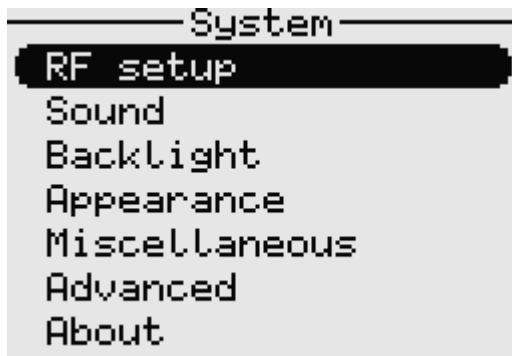
Various units of measurement can be displayed; metric and imperial supported.

GNSS data			GNSS data	
Satellite:	0/0		Latitude:	0.28365°
Distance:	0 m		Longitude:	-0.70269°
Speed:	0.0 m/s		Starting point	
Course:	0.0°		Latitude:	0.28365°
Altitude:	0 m	AGL	Longitude:	-0.70269°
Altitude:	0 m	MSL		

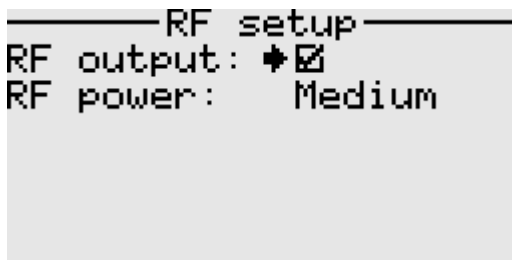
- **Satellites:** The number of satellites in use / in view. "Fix" is appended when we have a position fix.
- **Distance:** The calculated distance between the model's current location and the home location (starting point). If the displayed distance is inaccurate, simply reset the starting point from the context menu.
- **Speed:** The speed over ground. This is the speed at which your model is moving relative to the Earth's surface. The last received value is shown when there is no incoming telemetry or no position fix.
- **Course:** The course over ground. This is direction of movement of your model over the Earth's surface, irrespective of the direction your model is pointing. The last received value is shown when there is no incoming telemetry or no position fix.
- **Altitude AGL:** The altitude above ground level. If the value is inaccurate, reset it from the context menu. The last received value is shown when there is no incoming telemetry or no position fix.
- **Altitude MSL:** The altitude relative to mean sea level. The last received value is shown when there is no incoming telemetry or no position fix.
- **Latitude and Longitude:** The location coordinates of the model. Displays the last known location when there is no incoming telemetry or no position fix.
- **Starting point:** Displays the coordinates of the home location.

System settings

The System menu provides comprehensive configuration options so you can tailor the device to your needs. Settings are organized into categories for easy navigation and quick access to the options you want. Use this menu to adjust settings that affect overall system operation.

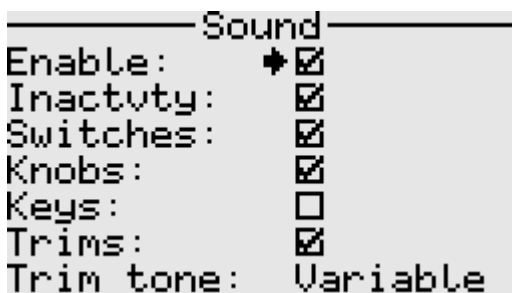


RF setup



- **RF output:** Toggle the RF transceiver on or off. When enabled, an RF icon appears on the home screen. RF output is automatically disabled when switching to a different model for safety, thus it has to be re-enabled manually after changing models.
- **RF power:** Adjust the transceiver's transmission power. Higher power increases range but uses more battery.

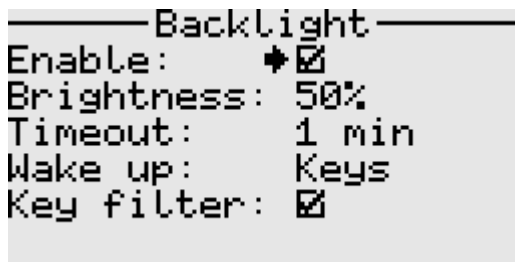
Sound



- **Enable:** Toggle all sounds on or off. When off, a mute icon appears on the home screen.
Holding the Down key while powering on will also mute all sounds.
- **Inactivity:** Turn the inactivity alarm on or off. When enabled, a warning tone plays after a period without user interaction.

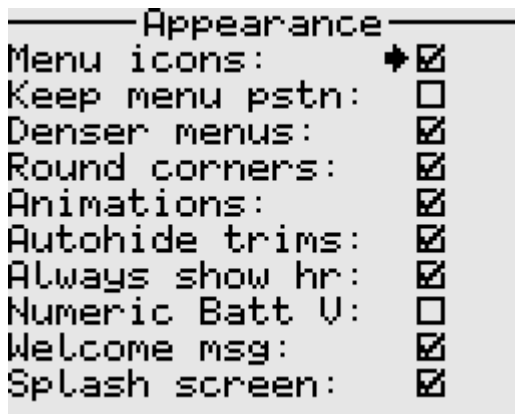
- **Switches:** Play a tone when any physical switch is moved.
- **Knobs:** Play a tone when a knob with a center detent is positioned at center.
- **Keys:** Play a tone when the physical UI buttons are pressed.
- **Trims:** Play a tone while trims are being adjusted.
- **Trim tone:** Set the trim tone behaviour. Fixed pitch (single frequency) or Variable pitch (changes with trim position).

Backlight



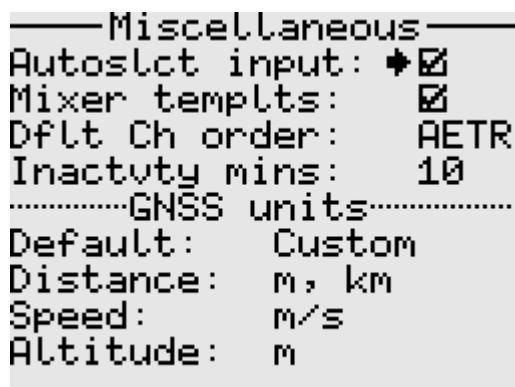
- **Enable:** Enables/disables the backlight. This may be useful for example to save energy on certain kinds of LCDs.
- **Brightness:** Controls the brightness level of the display. Higher brightness causes higher battery consumption.
- **Timeout:** Specifies the time before the backlight is turned off when the handset is inactive.
- **Wake up:** Specifies how the backlight is triggered on. Keys or Activity. When set to Keys, only the UI keys can wake up the backlight. Setting to Activity enables all the physical controls to wake up the backlight. This is useful when we want the backlight to stay on when operating a model, especially for LCDs that are not sunlight readable.
- **Key filter:** When enabled, the first key press only wakes the backlight without triggering any event in the User Interface. This setting is useful for LCDs that are not sunlight readable.

Appearance



- **Menu icons:** Show or hide icons in the main menu.
- **Keep menu position:** Whether to remember the scroll position in the major menus (Main menu, System, Extras, etc.). This setting does not apply to context menus.
- **Denser menus:** Increases the number of entries shown in the major menus.
- **Round corners:** Turns on/off rounded corners in menus, dialog boxes, etc.
- **Animations:** Turns animations on/off for toast messages, loading spinners, etc.
- **Autohide trims:** Hides the trim bars on the home screen when the trim buttons are not being interacted with.
- **Always show hours:** Whether to always show the hours digits for timers.
- **Numeric battery voltage:** Replaces the graphical battery gauge with the actual voltage readout on the home screen.
- **Welcome message:** Turns on/off the "Welcome" message when starting up the handset.
- **Splash screen:** Whether to show the user's custom splash screen during boot. To make a custom splash screen, create a monochrome bitmap image with 128x64 px resolution and save it as "SPLASH.BMP" inside the "IMAGES" folder on the SD card.

Miscellaneous



- **Inactivity minutes:** How long before the inactivity event is triggered, specifically for the inactivity alarm.
- **Auto select input:** This enables automatic detection of the moved physical control when editing sources or switches, so that we can quickly select the desired control without having to scroll through the options.

- **Mixer templates:** Whether to enable the default mixer template when creating new models. Turning off this also removes the entry from the mixer context menu.
- **Default channel order:** Specifies the default channel order when creating new models. E.g., selecting AETR sends Ail to Ch1, Ele to Ch2, Thr to Ch3, and Rud to Ch4 in the mixer. The order can always be overridden in the mixer; this option is merely a time saving feature for new models.
- **Inactivity minutes:** How long before the inactivity event is triggered, specifically for the inactivity alarm.
- **Default GNSS units:** Specifies the default units of measurement to use when adding the GNSS telemetry sensor template. Available options are Metric, Imperial, Custom, or None.
When set to Custom, the user can set custom defaults for Distance, Speed, and Altitude.
When set to None, the system prompts the user to select units whenever adding the GNSS sensor.

Advanced settings

This menu provides access to various advanced system settings. It is protected with a password (if set) to prevent unwanted configuration changes, for instance when we lend out the transmitter.



Sticks



- **Calibration:** This starts the stick calibration process.
- **Dead zone:** This allows to adjust the center dead zone for the stick axes, without re-triggering full calibration.

- **Default mode:** This determines the default stick axis mapping for the Aileron/Roll, Elevator/Pitch, Rudder/Yaw, and Throttle inputs. It is essentially called "Stick mode" in other RC systems.

Calibrating the sticks

```

-----Sticks-----
Type of axis
X1: ♦ Self-centering
Y1:  Non-centering
Z1:  Absent
X2:  Self-centering
-----
                        [Next]

```

```

-----Sticks-----
Move all stick axes
fully, then center
them. Proceed
when done.
-----
                        ♦[Next]

```

```

-----Sticks-----
Adjust deadzone
X1: ♦ 3%      (0)
Y1:  N/A      (-100)
Z1:  N/A      (0)
X2:  3%      (0)
-----
                        [Finish]

```

Procedure:

- Select the axis type: Self-centering (returns to the center), Non-centering or Absent.
- Move each stick axis through its full range. If an axis is self-centering, release it and let it return to center.
- Set the dead zone percentage. This applies around the center to prevent jitter when the stick is centered.

Properly calibrated stick axes always read between -100 to 100 when moved fully. If this is not the case, then redo the calibration, or check your hardware.

How often you need to recalibrate the sticks depends on their build quality and how frequently you use the device. As a guideline, recalibrate:

- After any noticeable drift or inconsistent input.
- After major firmware updates or hardware changes.

Knobs

```

-----Knobs-----
Calibrtn:  ♦[Start]
Deadzone:  [Adjust]

```

- **Calibration:** This starts the knob calibration process.

- **Dead zone:** This allows to adjust the center dead zone for the knobs, without re-triggering full calibration.

Calibrating the knobs

```

Knobs
Type of knob
KnobA: *Center detent
KnobB:  No detent
-----
                                [Next]

```

```

Knobs
Move all knobs
fully, then center
them. Proceed
when done.
-----
                                * [Next]

```

```

Knobs
Adjust deadzone
KnobA: *3%      (0)
KnobB:  N/A     (-100)
-----
                                [Finish]

```

Procedure:

- Select the knob type: Center detent (mechanical stop at center), No detent, or Absent.
- Rotate each knob through its full range. If a knob has a center detent, return it to the detent position.
- Set the dead zone percentage. Dead zone is applied around the center to prevent jitter when the knob is centered.

Properly calibrated knobs always read between -100 to 100 when moved fully. If this is not the case, then redo the calibration, or check your hardware.

Switches

This screen allows the user to specify the type of switches they have installed. Supported types are 2 position, 3 position, and their momentary variants. A frequent question is "How about push buttons?". Well, they are actually 2 position momentary switches.

```

Switches
SwA: *2 pos
SwB:  2 pos
SwC:  3 pos
SwD:  2 pos
SwE:  3 pos momentary
SwF:  2 pos momentary

```

Battery

```
-----Battery-----
Gauge min: 7.20 V
Gauge max: 8.00 V
Multiplr: 1242
(7.18 V)
```

- **Gauge min and max:** These determine the range of the transmitter battery gauge. The minimum value also serves as the alarm threshold value, below which a low battery warning is shown.
- **Multiplier:** This specifies the calibration factor for the transmitter battery voltage.

Calibrating the battery gauge

To calibrate the battery gauge, use a digital multimeter to measure the actual battery voltage at the terminals. Then adjust the multiplier until the displayed voltage on the transmitter matches what the multimeter is showing.

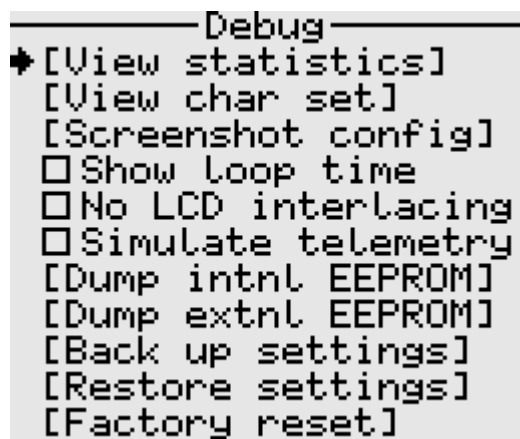
Security

```
-----Security-----
*☐ Lock models
☐ Lock startup
☐ Lock on inactvty
[Set password]
```

- **Lock models:** Locks the model manager screen, preventing access to the models.
- **Lock startup:** Locks the main menu on startup, effectively preventing changes to all settings (both model and system), unless the correct password is entered.
- **Lock on inactivity:** Locks the main menu after the system has been idle for the specified inactivity minutes. This setting applies only while the home screen is being displayed.
- **Set/Change password:** Opens the text edit dialog to edit the password. To remove the existing password, simply clear the field. Setting a password also protects the Advanced system menu.

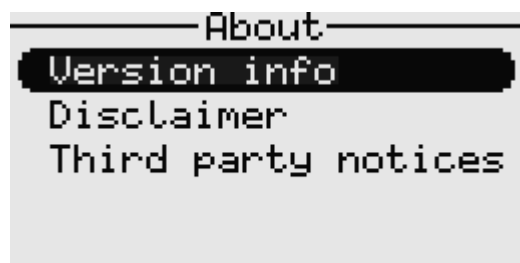
Debug

The Debug menu contains options intended primarily for troubleshooting, development, testing, and debugging.



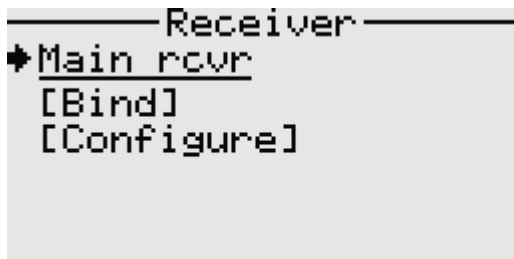
About

The About menu provides information regarding firmware version, legal notices, credits, and support/contact resources.



Receiver

Each receiver supports up to 10 channels. To use all the 20 channels, two receivers are required.



Binding to a receiver

A receiver can be bound as either a main receiver or a secondary receiver.

By default, RC channels 1 to 10 are handled by the main receiver, while RC channels 11 to 20 are handled by the secondary receiver. Only the main receiver can send back telemetry.

To bind, select the bind option, then cycle the power to the receiver. If the binding is successful, a "Success" toast message will be shown and a tune played.

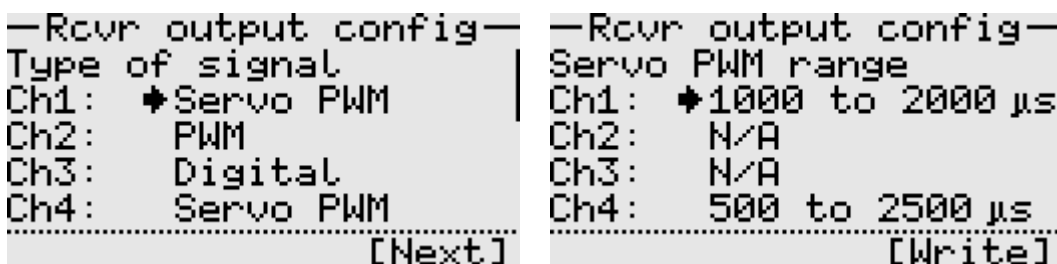
Configuring receiver outputs

The receiver outputs can be configured from the transmitter to any of the three signal types; servo PWM, digital on-off, or 'normal' PWM.

For example, 'normal' PWM output can be used to control brushed DC motors without the need for complex electronics.

The digital on-off output makes it easy to directly control components such as electromechanical relays and lights.

The servo PWM range can as well be adjusted to get extra travel from a servo, without making physical modifications to the servo.



Note:

1. These configuration settings are stored in the receiver, not the transmitter.
2. Normal PWM is only available on certain pins, depending on the pin mapping.

3. Any changes made take effect immediately upon pressing the 'Write' button.
4. In digital on-off mode, the output value range of -100 to -50 corresponds to LOW, -49 to 49 is ignored, and 50 to 100 corresponds to HIGH.
5. When reusing a receiver between models, always check and set the appropriate signal format before connecting any actuators to the receiver.

Frequently asked questions

Where are the mechanical CAD files?

As this is a DIY project, I did not make any detailed mechanical CAD; only a plan layout for the front plate of the transmitter. This is mainly because dimensions of parts differ widely across manufacturers.

Does it support protocol x?

Out of the box, no; there are just too many different and incompatible protocols. You can however modify the firmware and hardware to support any protocol or module you want. There are also several DIY projects that address this problem specifically, and interfacing to them would not be difficult.

Is the RF link stable and what is the range?

The RF link is stable enough. Keep in mind that this implementation is not designed for security, and is neither interference nor jamming free. The range largely depends on the specific RF module, power amplification setting, quality of your antennas, your environment, etc. From my tests, I easily got more than 2 km line of sight with monopole antennas and default LoRa settings, with packet loss of less than 3%. This range is more than necessary to control an RC model (of course you won't be able to see your model at such distance anyway).

What is the latency of this system? Servo jitter, lag?

Latency varies between 20 to 40 ms maximum between flicking a switch and getting the output on the receiver's pin. As for servo jitter, none; it is a matter of quality of your servos; I have not experienced any issues with cheap ones like the popular SG90 servos.

Why still use 8-bit AVR and not something more powerful like a 32-bit ARM microcontroller?

It is what I had lying around at the time. I initially planned to use an STM32 but the chip shortage for these forced me to rethink and revise the design. I found the Atmega2560 to be performant enough for this application after some clever code optimizations and performance tuning. In fact, it takes roughly 15 ms on average to compute everything including redrawing the screen.

Can it do voice alerts?

Voice alerts are not currently supported. For now, an alternative is to use custom notifications with tunes to report events. I plan on working on this in the near future, but I haven't yet found a compelling reason to add them.

SD card is not working or can't be detected.

The card should be formatted with the FAT (FAT16 or FAT32) file system. Other file systems are not supported.

Try to keep the number of files on the card minimal.
Always power the system off before inserting or removing the SD card.
Also try using a class 4 or lower, 4 GB or smaller SD card.

I am having trouble binding.

Double check your connections. Make sure the receiver has a stable supply voltage. Also leave enough space between the transmitter and the receiver. During binding, ensure that the power to the receiver is cycled within the binding window (typically 5 seconds), otherwise a timeout occurs.

The analog controls do not work. I am getting wrong readings when I move them.

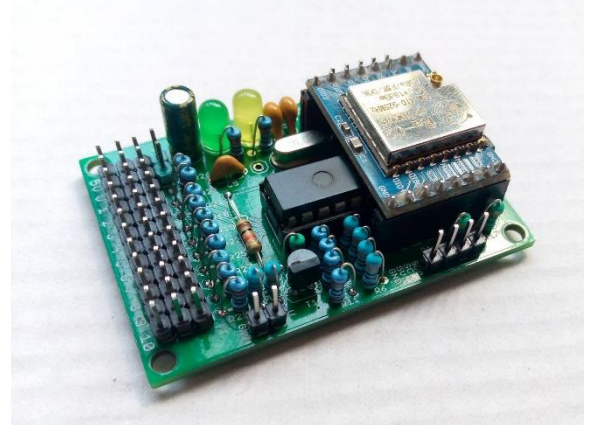
You probably skipped the calibration procedure, or you are doing it wrong. See the section about stick and knob calibration for the proper procedure. The quality of your hardware also matters, even though the system will try its best to cope with low quality gimbals.

If your readings appear reversed, check your connections. You may have to swap the VCC and GND wires on the problematic potentiometer.

Models and system settings are corrupted after a firmware update.

Ensure you back up your models to the SD card before performing any firmware updates. You can then restore them from the SD card afterwards.
To back up the system settings, use the corresponding option in the Debug menu.

Gallery



Additional information

For more information, visit <https://github.com/buk7456/FreeTX>

Disclaimer

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